

RUSTLIKE DESIGN DOC

A game by BREWSLABS (Caleb Gillis, Tyler Harvey, Scott Hendren, Gideon Rank, and Leif Rush)

Introduction

Game Summary

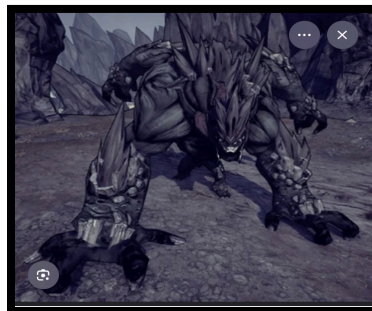
RUSTLIKE is a FPS roguelike, featuring a PvE wave-based combat loop. Players start on the same starting planet every run, and fight progressively harder waves of monsters (characterized by the planet they're currently on). As players progress, eventually the only option is to escape the current planet and go to the next to continue the run. Along the way, players can also find research components to upgrade weapons in current *and future* runs. Eventually the player will have visited all planets which is a general win condition, but players can choose to keep playing to reach new high scores.

Inspiration



The main inspirations we discussed as a team would be games like Megabonk, another 3D indie roguelike. The pace of this game intensifies as you live longer, which is what we'd like to achieve too. In addition, for movement, we're interested in trying to achieve a quake-like movement system.

For general aesthetic, we want the game to feel light-hearted and comedic, with inspirations like Futurama and Loons: The Fight for Fame, but still with a dystopian feel, maybe similar to Borderlands 2.



Player Experience

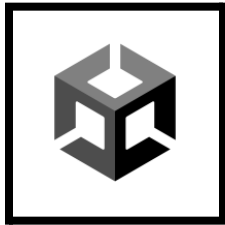
We want players to have a fun action-packed, fast-paced experience. We'll focus on movement and attack mechanics so the game feels satisfying to play, and we'll focus on balancing weapons, abilities, and

enemies to ensure an even progression and replayability. The UI and general interaction in the game will be simple, but the actions players take will be the defining factor in a given run.

Platform

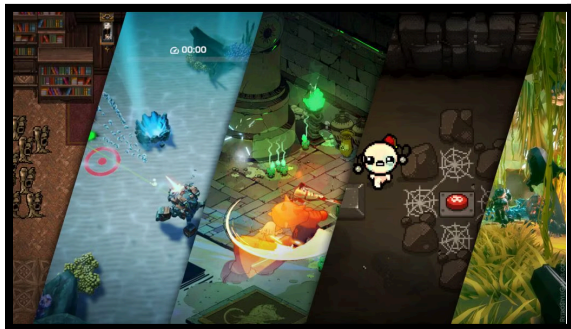
We'll be developing RUSTLIKE for Windows and Mac, using Unity's built-in project management tools. If we end up publishing the game, we think that mobile could also possibly be an option.

Development Software



We will be choosing Unity as our Game Engine for this project. Along with this, we'll use VSCode and AI tools to help with software development for the project. We'll be using GitHub for version control, and using ignores can avoid using LFS. In addition, we will use Kanban boards in GitHub to keep track of tasks. And Blender for asset creation.

Genre



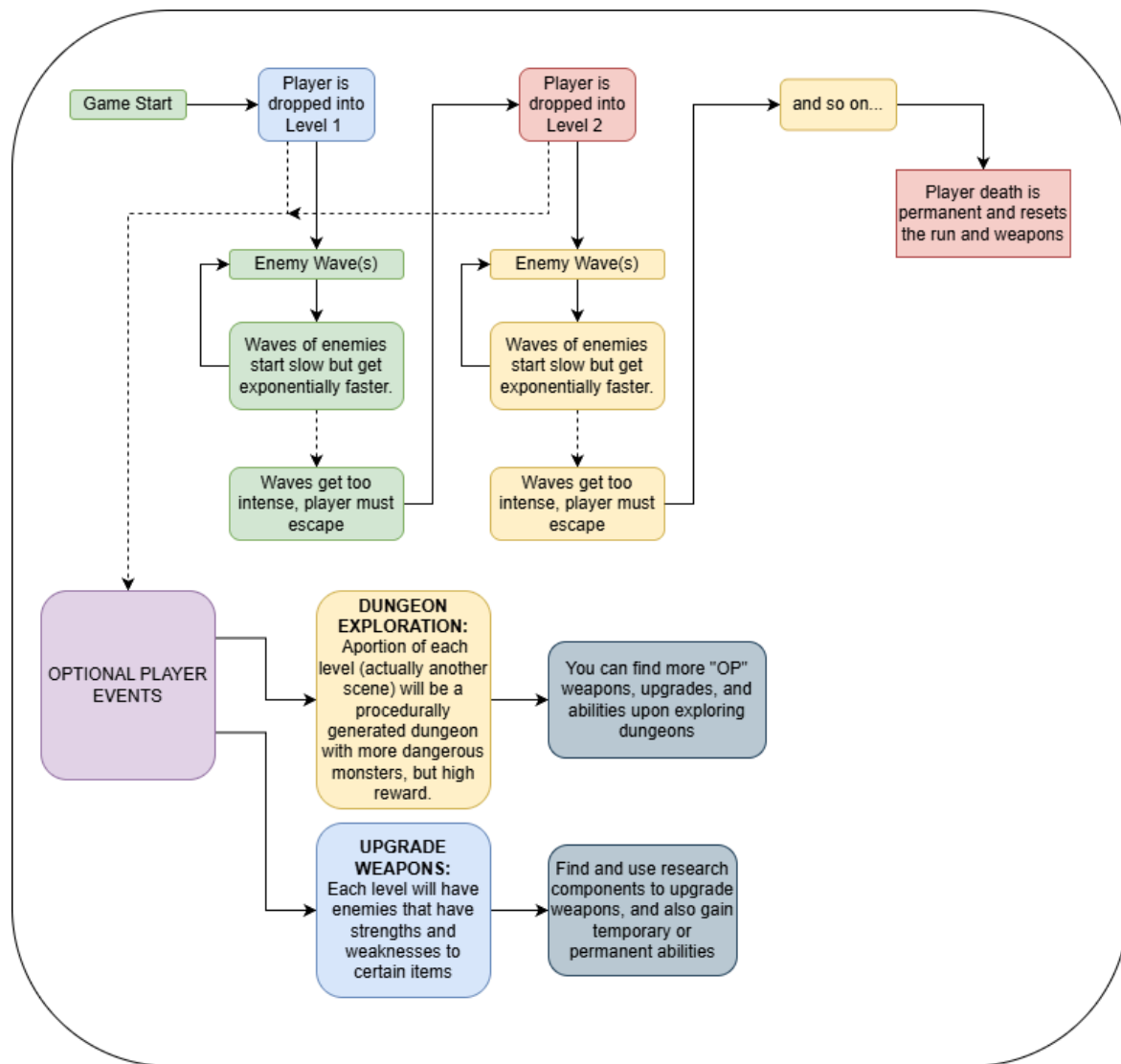
Although RUSTLIKE is a combination of genres, the main is a **wave-based roguelike**. The general win condition is the longest time alive.

Target Audience

Our primary audience is teens and young adults. If we had to rate this game, it'd probably be 'T'. There will be mild gore and violence, but it will still be light-hearted and comedic as described earlier.

Concept

Gameplay overview



The general gameplay loop is followed on the flowchart above. Players are “dropped” into the first level, encountering basic enemies, along with upgrades and abilities. They have the choice to explore the dungeon in each level, which is a procedurally generated area in the map where you can find more OP loot, but also face harder enemies.

Eventually, the current world will be overrun with enemies and be extremely hard to hold back. In that case, you can choose to leave in your space-ship to the next planet, and the loop repeats, with each planet getting substantially harder.

Theme Interpretation

Styled similar to the game 'Megabonk', where the goal is to survive as long as possible by upgrading the player characters' weapons and abilities. Waves of enemies continuously grow and become more difficult so there will always be a need to increase the player's damage, health, and maneuverability.

Primary Mechanics

- **Roguelike:** Each run starts from the same starting world, and death is permanent for a run. The only thing that persists through runs are the research components (used to upgrade weapons to make progression easier the more you play to get to where you left off)
- **Wave-based enemies:** Players will face waves of different classes and difficulties of enemies, and each wave is more difficult than the last.
- **Procedural Generation:** Parts of each planet will have procedural generation to keep exploring fresh
- **Fast-paced:** Movement and general mechanics will be fast, (similar to Quake and Megabonk), and you can kill enemies, but also die, very quickly (depending on class and difficulty)
- **Endgame / Win condition:** After players discover all the planets, the main win condition is just getting the highest score (longest time) in the run.

Secondary Mechanics

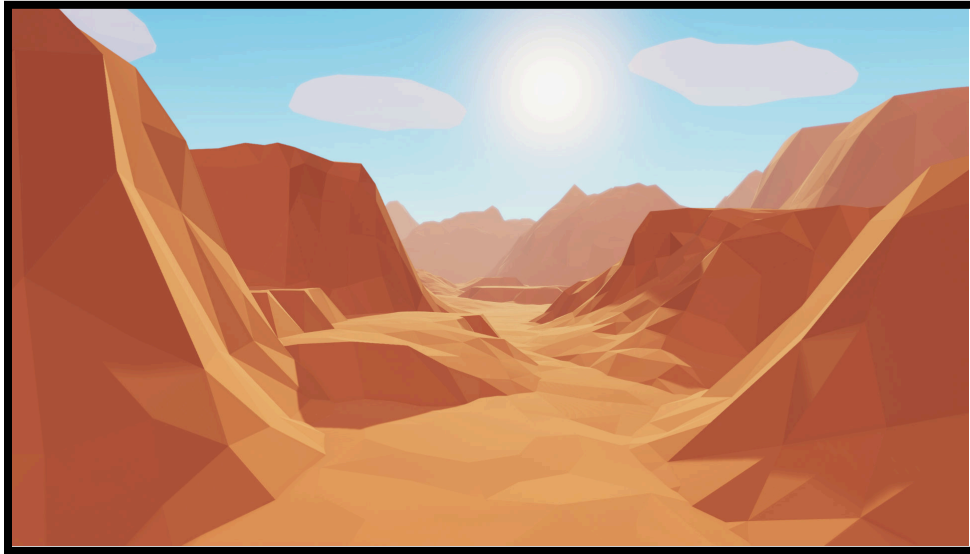
- **ENEMIES SPREADSHEET**
- **WEAPONS:**
 - Gun / Projectile Shooter (in upgradable order)
 - Planet 1: "Glock", Plasma/EMP gun, Turret
 - Planet 2: Laser Pistol, Laser Full Auto Rifle
 - Planet 3: Grenade Launcher, RPG
 - Melee
 - Constant melee ability (example: COD)
- **ABILITIES:**
 - Jump Height / Bounce (1 time use w/ cooldown)
 - Movement Speed (for a certain duration w/ cooldown)
 - Increased Fire Rate (for a certain duration w/ cooldown)

- Invulnerability (Bubble for a certain duration)
- Stimmy (short boost of health)
- Other
- **Upgrades / Items / Pickups:**
 - Weapons (guns/melee)
 - Health pots
 - Ability Swap (Changes current ability, see Ability section)
 - Ability Upgrade (Buffs current ability, EX: Movement Speed increased +5%)
 - Global Upgrades (Stay w/ player for the entire game)
 - Fire rate
 - Damage
 - Health
 - Armor
 - Movement Speed
 - Jump Height-Jetpack
 - Other
- **PLANETS:**
 - **LEVEL 1:** Robot
 - **LEVEL 2:** Aliens
 - **LEVEL 3:** Rock
 - **And so on...**
- **RESEARCH COMPONENTS:** Research components can be found around the map and persist between runs. Weapons can be purchased before each run and can also get upgraded with research components (possibly different kinds?)
- **Level Design**
 - Main Planets
 - Wave based enemies
 - Static worlds (No generation)
 - Central gravity (Player pulled to planet center)
 - Dungeons inside planets?
 - Separate Scenes to load and generate levels using 'block based' rooms to create a new experience inside each dungeon
 - Wave based or static spawned enemies
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Art

Theme Interpretation

The game will have an art style similar to the TV show 'Futurama', low-poly, cartoonish to give the world a simple view from simple colors and shading.



Design

The UI will consist of a simple HUD displaying player health, weapon type, ability, etc. There will also be upgrade trees/inventories/menus styled in a similar way with not too many details, but displays enough to give the player the required information to understand it.

Audio

Music

- Fun, immersive, thrill-seeking? music, cartoonish

The music style will be cartoony to immerse the player with thrill seeking, sometimes anxiety inducing, music.

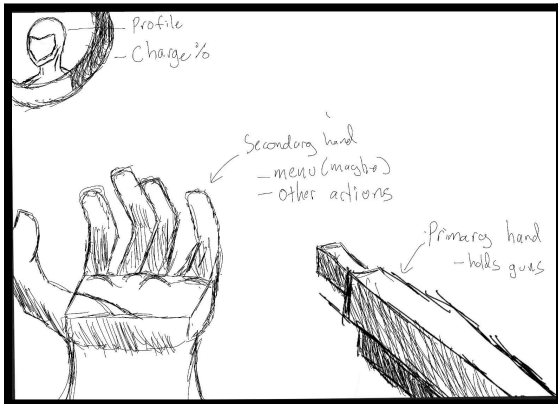
Sound Effects

Sound effects will consist of obnoxious yet satisfying sound clips to make things like jumping, shooting, and killing enemies more enjoyable.

Game Experience

UI

Our UI will be designed to be as simple as possible, so players can get information quickly when the game is at “full speed” We’ll do this with simple indicators, and a simple general UI so the player doesn’t have too much to look at.



Controls

- General WASD, SPACE to jump, E to use ability, F to Interact, and mouse to rotate camera
- First person

Development Timeline

Our development timeline can easily be referenced on our [GitHub](#). We’ve split up our tasks to complete in a [Kanban board](#), also on the GitHub.

Roles

- **Team Lead:** Scott
- **Programming:** Caleb, Lief, Tyler, Scott
- **Modeling:** Gideon, Leif, Tyler

- **Design (UI/Systems):** Leif, Gideon
- **Art / Music:** Caleb, Leif, Tyler